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SUPERSEDING
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December 8, 1965

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BINDERS, LOOSE-LEAF (FOR TABULATING MACHINE PAPER); AND ACCESSORIES

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers requirements for flexible-post binders for containing unburst and burst marginal-punched tabulating machine paper and accessories thereto. Covers are separable and have a binding mechanism with locking devices for containment of contents (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Binders.

1.2.1.1 Types, classes, styles, and grades. Types, classes, styles, and grades of binders shall be as follows (see 6.2):

Type I - For continuous, unburst, marginal-punched tabulating sheets.
Type II - For individual, burst, marginal-punched tabulating sheets.
Class 1 - Top and bottom loading.
Class 2 - Top loading.
Style A - Inside locking mechanism.
  Grade A - Plastic bound, stiff covers.
  Grade B - Coated cloth bound, stiff covers.
  Grade C - Duck (Canvas) bound, stiff covers.
  Grade D - Pressboard, flexible covers.
Style B - Outside locking mechanism.
  Grade B - Coated cloth bound, stiff covers.
  Grade C - Duck (Canvas) bound, stiff covers.

1.2.1.2 Sheet size (dimensions), capacity and posts. Sheet size and capacity shall be as specified in the invitation for bids, contract, or order (see 6.2). The first dimension cited for the sheet size shall be the binding side. Not less than two flexible posts (see 3.9) shall be furnished with each binder, and shall be of sufficient length to meet the capacity requirement specified.

1.2.1.3 Color. Color of binders shall be as specified in the invitation for bids, contract, or order (see 6.2).

1.2.2 Accessories. Accessories include suspension (hanger) bars (3.8), and replacement posts (3.9). Accessories shall be furnished as specified in the invitation for bid, contract or order (see 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

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Federal Specifications:

L-P-394 - Plastic Molding Material (Propylene Plastics, Injection and Extrusion).
UU-P-701 - Pressboard; Colored.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes; Paperboard, Metal Edged and Components.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191/GEN (General Provisions) - Textile Test Methods.
Fed. Test Method 191/5041 - Determination of Weight of Textile Materials: Small Specimen Method.
Fed. Test Method 191/5100 - Breaking Strength and Elongation, of Woven Cloth; Grab Method.
Fed. Test Method 191/5651 - Crocking of Woven and Knitted Cloth; Standard Sample Munsell Scale Method.
Fed. Test Method 191/5874 - Temperature, Low, Effect on Coated Cloth.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York , Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seatle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specification procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Publications:

ASTM D 638 - Tensile Properties of Plastics.
ASTM D 789 - Nylon Injection Molding and Extrusion Materials.
ASTM D 1004 - Tear Resistance of Plastic Film and Sheeting.
ASTM D 1788 - Rigid Acrylonitrile-Butadiene-Styrene (ABS) Plastics.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Publications:

T410 - Weight Per Unit Area (Basis Weight or Substance) of Paper and Paperboard.
T411 - Thickness (Caliper) of Paper and Paperboard.
T807 - Bursting Strength of Paperboard and Linerboard.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, 360 Lexington Avenue, New York, NY 10017.)

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National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Details of material required not definitely specified shall be in accordance with good commercial quality for the purpose intended. Exposed metal surfaces shall have a polished finished and shall be corrosion resistant or treated to resist corrosion, except binding mechanisms for style B binders may be painted. Unless otherwise specified, cold-rolled steel shall be quarter-hard temper.

3.1.1 Plastic. Plastic for grade A binders shall be of virgin vinyl, 0.018 inch ± 0.002 inch in thickness. Plasticizer shall be adequate to provide flexibility for resistance to drying and cracking to the finished vinyl when the binders are in use. The vinyl shall be nonmigratory and flexible, and shall have the physical characteristics shown in table I (see 4.1.1). Unless otherwise specified, the vinyl shall have a shallow grain finish.

TABLE I. Physical characteristics

Characteristics	Value
Tensile strength at yield, each direction p.s.i., minimum	2200
Tear resistance, each direction, pounds, minimum	6.0
Cold crack at -20° ± 2°F.	No evidence of cracking when tested as specified in 4.1.1.

3.1.2 Coated cloth (grade B binders).

3.1.2.1 Base cloth. The base cloth shall be a balanced woven cotton cloth weighing not less than 2.9 ounces per square yard and shall have not more than 3 percent nonfibrous material (see 4.1.1).

3.1.2.2 Coating compound. The coating compound shall be virgin plastic formulated from any of the following materials: ethyl cellulose, cellulose acetate, polyvinyl chloride, or polyvinyl chloride-acetate. Plasticizer shall be adequate to provide flexibility for resistance to drying and cracking of the finished coated cloth when binders are in use. The coating shall not crack through to the base cloth when tested in accordance with 4.1.1. The weight shall be not less than 6.0 ounces per square yard.

3.1.2.3 Finished coated cloth. The finished coated cloth shall consist of the base cloth and the coating compound. The base cloth shall be evenly and smoothly coated with coating compound on the face side, and shall be free from fisheyes, holes, cracks, or other defects. The finished cloth shall have a minimum breaking strength of 45 pounds in the warp direction and 40 pounds in the filling direction. The weight of the finished cloth shall be not less than 8.9 ounces per square yard. The finished coated cloth shall have a colorfastness to crocking rating of at least "good" when tested in accordance with 4.1.1. Unless otherwise specified, the coated cloth shall have a shallow grain finish.

3.1.3 Duck (grade C binders). The duck cloth shall be not less than 7.0 ounces per square yard. The duck shall have a colorfastness to crocking rating of at least "good", and the breaking strength shall be not less than 95 pounds in the warp direction and 57 pounds in the filling direction (see 4.1.1).

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3.1.4 Paperboard. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2): Paperboard for grade A plastic bound binders shall be not less than 0.210 inch in thickness and shall have a bursting strength of not less than 700 points when tested in accordance with 4.1.1. Paperboard for grade B coated cloth bound binders shall be not less than 0.175 inch in thickness and shall have a bursting strength of not less than 550 points when tested in accordance with 4.1.1. Paperboard for grade C canvas bound binders shall be not less than 0.165 inch in thickness and shall have a bursting strength of not less than 500 points when tested in accordance with 4.1.1. The paperboard shall be free from surface lumps, indentations and mechanical imperfections, and be reasonably smooth and flat.

3.1.5 Pressboard. Pressboard for grade D binders shall be 0.020-inch in thickness, conforming to type I of UU-P-701.

3.1.6 Paper lining. The paper lining material for inside faces of covers, when required, shall have a basis weight of not less than 60 pounds (25 by 38 inches - 500 sheets) when tested in accordance with 4.1.1. The color of the lining shall harmonize with the binding material.

3.2 Design. Binders with stiff covers shall lay flat on desk tops or other even surfaces. Sheets filed in all binders shall lay flat so there will be no hidden entries when in use. Binders shall be designed for satisfactory performance, including loading and unloading of binders and for proper retention and performance of posts.

3.2.1 Type I. Type I binders shall be designed for containing continuous, unburst, marginal-punched tabulating sheets by means of flexible posts secured by a locking device in the binding mechanism.

3.2.2 Type II. Type II binders shall be designed for containing individual, burst, marginal-punched tabulating sheets by the same means as specified for type I binders in 3.2.1.

3.2.3 Class 1. Class 1 binders shall be designed for loading or withdrawal of sheets from the top and bottom of the binder.

3.2.4 Class 2. Class 2 binders shall be designed for loading and withdrawal of sheets from the top of the binder only.

3.2.5 Style A. Style A binders shall be designed so that the cover stubs turn into the binder and have an inside locking mechanism.

3.2.6 Style B. Style B binders shall be of a mechanical hinge, piano style, with an outside locking mechanism in the top hinge plate. Binders shall be designed for loading from the top only.

3.3 Construction (general). Each binders shall consist of two separable covers, hinged to cover stubs or plates, as applicable, for containment of a binding mechanism. Construction shall be such that no parts of the binders will mar smooth surfaces such as desks, tables, and bookcase shelves. Metal hinge components shall be secure and properly aligned. Hinges shall be recessed into plates in accordance with normal commercial practice, and plates and covers shall lay flat on smooth, even surfaces. Covers shall have round corners on the side of the binder, parallel to the binding side. The outside dimensions of binders of the same sheet size shall be approximately the same.

3.4 Covers, hinges, and mounting stubs or plates, as applicable, for binding mechansim.

3.4.1 Style A, grades A through D.

3.4.1.1 Grade A, plastic bound, stiff covers. Covers shall be paperboard as specified in 3.1.4, with grooved (offset) construction on the inside to accept the binding mechanism when binder is in closed position and to enable the binder to be stacked flat. The binding material shall be plastic as specified in 3.1.1. The plastic shall completely cover the inner and outer surfaces of the board, extending beyond the covers to fabricate the hinges and stubs. Hinges shall consist of at least the two layers of plastic which extend from the covers and shall be reinforced over the entire area of hinge with vinyl-impregnated nylon cloth, or by other means which will provide equivalent reinforcing strength and flexibility to that of the specified cloth. A strip of black-fiberboard, or equivalent, 0.045 ± 0.003 inch in thickness and the approximate width of the binding mechanism, shall be bound into each cover stub for reinforcement and mounting of the binding mechanism. All edges of the binding material shall be heat sealed.

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3.4.1.2 Grade B coated-cloth bound, stiff covers. Covers shall be paperboard specified in 3.1.4, bound with coated cloth, as specified in 3.1.2, securely glued over the entire area of contact with the covers. The coated-cloth binding for each cover, including hinge and stub, shall be of one-piece construction (without splices). The binding material shall be carried over the inside surfaces of the covers, except the binding edge, at least 3/8 inch. On the binding side, the coated cloth shall extend beyond the edge to fabricate the hinge and fold back on the inside of the binder cover in a manner to completely cover the stub and reinforcing material, overlapping the binding edge of the cover at least 1-1/4 inches. The overlap at the top and bottom edges of covers shall extent to overlap the top and bottom edges of the hinges and stubs for the same distance as on the covers.

The overlapping binding material shall be secure to the covers and hinge in a manner that the edges are neatly and securely turned in and there are no frayed or loose ends which will tear or pull out when the binder is in normal use. Each cover hinge shall be glued together and stubs shall be reinforced with black fiberboard, or equivalent, 0.030 ± 0.002 inch in thickness and the approximate width of the binding mechanism.

A paper lining as specified in 3.1.6, shall be securely glued over the entire area of contact with the inner surfaces of the covers and with the binding material. The lining shall overlap the turned under edges of the binding material.

3.4.1.3 Grade C duck-bound, stiff covers. Covers shall be paperboard specified in 3.1.4, bound with duck as specified in 3.1.3. Construction of covers and hinges shall be as specified in 3.4.1.2 for grade B, coated-cloth binders, except that hinges shall be reinforced between the two layers of binding material with at least one strip of duck as specified in 3.1.3. The reinforcing strips shall be securely glued or otherwise attached to the top and bottom hinges. Alternate reinforcing material and technique may be used in hinges if equivalent reinforcing strength is provided.

3.4.1.4 Grade D, pressboard, flexible covers. Covers shall be of pressboard as specified in 3.1.5. Pressboard shall be scored at the hinges, and stubs shall be fashioned to support the binding mechanism in accordance with normal commercial practice.

3.4.2 Style B, grades B and C. Covers shall be paperboard specified in 3.1.4, bound with coated cloth as specified in 3.1.2, or duck as specified in 3.1.3, as applicable. Binding shall be securely glued over the entire area of contact with the covers. It shall be carried over the inside surfaces of the covers at least 3/8 inch. A paper lining as specified in 3.1.6, shall be securely glued over the entire area of contact with the inner surfaces of the covers and with the binding material. Lining on inside of each cover shall overlap the turned under edge of the binding material, and shall overlap and be secured to each metal hinge plate, attached to the cover, in accordance with standard commercial practice.

3.5 Binding mechanisms. Post holes shall be provided in both top and bottom covers to receive and securely retain flexible posts. All binders shall have two post holes spaced on proper centers to utilize sprocket feed holes of the sheet size specified (see 1.2.1.2). Requirements for additional post holes (multiple spacing) shall be as specified (see 6.2).

3.5.1 Types I and II, class 1, style A.

3.5.1.1 Grades A and B. Grades A and B binding mechanisms shall consist of two channel bars fabricated from cold-rolled steel not less than 0.033-inch in thickness. One channel bar shall be attached to each cover stub by at least three metal rivets or grommets. One rivet or grommet shall be positioned in the center and one near each end of the binding mechanism. The rivets or grommets shall have sufficient upset to permanently secure the channel bars to the cover stub. Each channel bar shall have post holes in the number and with center spacing specified, and shall be fitted with two slide locks to secure the flexible posts. Stops for slide locks shall be provided in each channel bar. The slide locks shall be made of steel or plastic material. Plastic slide locks shall conform to 1-2-1 of ASTM D 1788. Slide locks shall be of sufficient thickness and design to withstand repeated opening and closing. When covers are attached to the binding mechanism, post holes shall be in alignment.

3.5.1.2 Grades C and D. Grades C and D binding mechanisms shall be as specified in 3.5.1.1 except that steel channel bars shall be not less than 0.023-inch in thickness. As an alternate construction, grade D binding mechanisms may be fabricated from 0.040-inch thick plastic conforming to 1-2-1 of ASTM D 1788.

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3.5.2 Types I and II, class 2, style A, grades A through D. Types I and II, class 2, style A, grades A through D binding mechanisms shall be as specified in 3.5.1 for the respective grade binder, except the bottom channel bar shall be without slide locks and shall have post holes to accept the flexible posts. Alternately, at the option of the manufacturer, a steel plate or bar with post holes to accept the flexible posts may be furnished in place of the bottom channel bar, provided it is equal or greater in thickness to the channel bar specified above.

3.5.3 Types I and II, class 2, style B, grades B and C. Types I and II, class 2, style B, grades B and C binders shall have a hinged type, combination metal and plastic binding mechanism. One part of the hinge shall be permanently attached to each cover and is identified hereinafter as the hinge plate. A second part shall receive the flexible posts and is identified hereinafter as the post housing. The hinge plate and post housing shall be joined by a piano style hinge with a steel pin. The pin shall be fitted in a manner that the pin will not protrude from the hinge or fall out during use.

The hinge plate shall be made from cold-rolled steel, not less than 0.033 inch in thickness, and shall overlap the inner surface of the respective cover at least 1-3/16 inches and the length shall be the designated sheet size $\pm$ 1/4 inch.

Each post housing shall have post holes in the number and with center to center spacing specified, and shall be made of plastic conforming to 1-2-1 of ASTM D 1788. The top cover post housing shall have two sliding or latch-type locking devices, one on or near each end of the housing to secure flexible posts. The bottom cover post housing shall have post holes to accept the flexible posts.

The sliding locking devices shall be made of cold-rolled steel, not less than 0.023 inch in thickness and of sufficient width to slide over and cover the flexible posts, or plastic material conforming to 1-2-1 of ASTM D 1788. A pull device and a slide stop shall be provided on each sliding locking devices.

3.6 Special features. When specified in the invitation for bids, the following special features shall be incorporated in the binder (see 6.2):

3.6.1 Label holders and labels. A label holder, including label, shall be fabricated in accordance with normal commercial Practice, except that plastic label holder, when specified, shall not be of the cellulose nitrate type. Label holders and labels shall be of the size (dimensions) and located on the binder as specified (see 6.2). Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the label holder shall be built into or otherwise securely attached to the binder and shall be nonremovable. The label holder shall be constructed so that the label can be readily inserted and removed, and in a manner that the label will be retained and not fall out when binder is in normal use. There shall be no unfinished edges around the label holder and the construction shall be such that the binding material will not tear, fray, or pull out in normal use. Binders furnished with label holders shall be designed and fabricated in a manner that the holders will not weaken the structure of the binder nor mar smooth surfaces.

3.6.1.1 Grade D pressboard binders only. When specified (see 6.2), binders shall be furnished with an embossed label panel on the top cover. The size and position of the label panel shall be specified (see 6.2). A gummed paper label shall be furnished with each binder requiring a label panel.

3.7 Identification of product marking. The manufacturer's name or trademark of such known character as to be readily identifiable, shall be printed, stamped, or silk screened, as applicable, on the inside of one cover of the binder. When specified, the words "Property U.S. Government," shall be included in the marking.

3.8 Suspension (hanger) bars. Suspension (hanger) bars shall be designed for use with binder racks or cabinets. Bar shall be compatible for use with the binder rack or cabinet specified (see 6.2).

3.9 Posts. Posts for class 1 binders (top and bottom loading) shall be nylon or wire fully encased in plastic, at the option of the manufacturer (see 3.9.1 and 3.9.2). Nylon posts for the class 1 binder shall have both ends tapered. Posts for class 2 binders (top loading) shall be nylon with one end tapered and a slotted head on the opposite end. The diameter of the head shall be larger than that of the post in accordance with good commercial practice. When heads of posts are recessed in the binder, slots shall be designed and construed in a manner to permit tightening or removal of posts (see 6.3). Posts shall be flexible and sufficiently stable so as not to loosen in the binding mechanism nor break or take a permanent set when compressed by the locking device(s). Posts shall be designed and constructed for easy and ready flexing and passage through eyelets and contents of binder without binding, fraying, spreading, or otherwise becoming deformed. Replacement posts shall be furnished as specified in the invitation for bid, contract, or order (see 6.2).

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3.9.1 Nylon posts. Posts shall be nylon conforming to ASTM D 789 and 0.125 ± 0.004 inch in diameter.

3.9.2 Combination wire and plastic posts. The posts shall consist of at least seven strands of No. 22 annealed, galvanized wire encased in plastic conforming to Type I of L-P-394. The plastic shall completely encase the wire, including the ends. The posts shall be not less than 0.112 inch nor more than 0.130 inch in outside diameter.

3.10 Workmanship. The binders shall be well finished, clean, and all edges shall be smooth. Metal parts of binders shall be free from burrs and rough or sharp edges. The coated cloth and duck binding materials at the corners of the binder covers shall be well-turned and shall be securely attached to the paperboard and paper lining. The binders shall have no defects which might affect the serviceability of the items and shall be free from any defects which affect the appearance of the product.

3.11 Assembly and loading instructions. These instructions shall be furnished with each binder, located on the lining of one cover or on the inner surface of pressboard binders, as applicable. If not contained in the binder, instructions may be enclosed in the envelope containing the flexible posts furnished with the respective binders specified. Instructions shall be legible, comprehensive, and complete. (See 5.1.1.3.)

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsibile for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Examination and testing of components and materials. The supplier is responsible for insuring that all components and materials used in fabricating binders were manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with this specification or referenced subsidiary specifications. Component testing shall be performed on the following materials received at one time, of the same type and color, manufactured at the same source and essentially under the same conditions, and identified as used in the production of the quantity of the end items. The supplier shall maintain records of components and material testing. These records shall be available to the authorized Government representative, and shall include the source, date of receipt, component material designation, date of test(s), test data, and quantity of material represented by the test report. Each component test report must be within the period of the contract, or within the time authorized in the contract for production of standby stock in advance of the ordering period. Unless otherwise specified, the sample size shall be the sample unit specified in the applicable test method, selected at random within the shipment.

Vinyl. Vinyl used in fabricating grade A binders shall be tested in accordance with the following test methods to determine conformance with the requirements of table I (3.1.1).

	Test Method
Tensile strength at yield	D 638 - American Society for Testing and Materials
Tear resistance	D 1004 - American Society for Testing and Materials
Cold crack (see note below)	5874 - Fed. Test Method Std. 191

NOTE: Five specimens shall be taken from each lot of material received, and the sample of vinyl is considered to pass if 4 of the 5 individual specimens conform to the cold crack requirements.

Determination of total weight, coating weight, and base weight of coated cloth. The total weight shall be determined in accordance with method 5041 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 (see 3.1.2). The same specimens shall then be used to determine the weight of the coating and the weight of the base cloth in accordance with the following procedure:

Soak the back of the specimens with cyclohexanone or other suitable solvent to assist in stripping the coating from the cloth (flash coated materials may be totally immersed in a container of solvent prior to stripping). The cloth, as well as any loose fibers or yarns that may have been separated from the piece during stripping, shall be immersed in hot cyclohexanone (approximately 92°C. (180°F.)) for two to five hours, then thoroughly rinsed with methyl ethyl ketone, dried, and reweighed. The loss in weight of the specimen will indicate the weight of the coating and supply the base cloth weight (see 3.1.2).

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Test for cracking. One specimen, 8 by 8-inches, shall be taken from each 100 linear yards of coated cloth. Each specimen shall be tested as follows: Crease the test specimen to form a crease parallel to the direction of the filling yards of the base cloth. A 10 pound metal roller approximately 5-1/2 inches in diameter and 2 inches in width with a suitable handle shall be rolled one time over the coated cloth specimen while the specimen rests on a hard surface. It shall then be folded in the same position, but the opposite direction and the weight again applied. The specimen shall then be visually examined for cracking or flaking which, if evident, shall be cause for rejection (see 3.1.2).

Breaking strength and colorfastness to crocking of finished coated cloth. Breaking strength and colorfastness to crocking of the finished coated cloth shall be determined in accordance with methods 5100 and 5651, respectively, of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 (see 3.1.2).

Duck. Duck shall be tested in accordance with the following test methods of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 (see 3.1.3).

Weight	-	method 5041
Colorfastness to crocking	-	method 5651
Breaking strength	-	method 5100

Paperboard. The thickness and bursting strength of paperboard shall be determined as described in TAPPI Test Method T411, and T807, respectively (see 3.1.4).

Pressboard. Pressboard shall be tested in accordance with the requirements of UU-P-701 (see 3.1.5).

Paper lining. The basis weight of paper lining shall be determined in accordance with TAPPI Test Method T410 (see 3.1.6).

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Lot. A lot shall consist of all the binders presented for inspection at one time as defined in MIL-STD-105.

4.2.2 Sampling of end-item for visual defects. A random sample of binders shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level I. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall not exceed 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one binder.

4.2.3 Sampling for preparation for delivery requirements. For examination of interior packages the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, and selected at random just prior to the closing operation. Closure defects shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level I. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall not exceed 4.0 percent defective.

4.2.4 Sampling for end-item operational performance test. A random sample of binders shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-2. The AQL shall not exceed 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one binder.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual and dimensional examination of end-item. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for defects listed in table II. Any sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected.

TABLE II. Examination for visual defects (end items)

Examine	Defects
Binder components and flexible posts.	Binder not type, class, style, grade, color, or capacity specified. Quantity of flexible posts accompanying each binder not as specified. Binder covers not flat (see 3.2.) (See Note). Construction (general) not as specified, as applicable (see 3.3). Covers, hinges, and mounting stubs or plates, as applicable, not as specified for style and grade (see 3.4.1.1, 3.4.1.2, 3.4.1.3, 3.4.1.4, and 3.4.2). Binding mechanisms, as applicable, not as specified for classification (see 3.5 through 3.5.3).

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TABLE II. Examination for visual defects (end items) (con.)

Examine	Defects
Binder components and	Special features not as specified, as applicable (see 3.6, 3.6.1, and 3.6.1.1). Label holder not as specified or missing, when required (see 3.6.1 and 3.6.1.1). Identification of product marking not as specified (see 3.7). Post not as specified (see 3.9). Workmanship not as specified (see 3.10). Instructions for assembly and loading not as specified; missing (see 3.11).

NOTE: The criteria for establishing whether binders with stiff covers are flat shall be as follows: Place each cover (top and bottom) being examined on a table top with a smooth horizontal plane larger than the binder covers, lining side up, and measure the visable gap at the periphery of the cover between the cover and the table top. The maximum allowable gap at any spot shall not exceed 1/8 inch.

4.3.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be examined to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table III.

TABLE III. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examine	Defects
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted;incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials (containers)	Not as specified. Any component missing; damaged in a manner to affect serviceability.
Closure of shipping containers	Not as specified.
Contents and weight, interior and exterior, as applicable	Quantity of binders not as specified. Gross or net weight exceeds limitation.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps; loose bands; inadequate sealing, strapping or stapling, as applicable. Bulged or distorted containers.
Packaging and packing containers	Not type, class, style, etc., specified as applicable.

4.3.3 Examination for operational performance of binding mechanism. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be subjected to the following operational performance test:

The binders shall be assembled and loaded with 2 inches of material of the sheet size applicable to the binder in accordance with the manufacturer's instructions in or accompanying the binder as specified herein. Any nonconformance of the binder components with the requirements specified herein, as applicable, or with the manufacturer's instructions, will be considered a defect. Locking devices shall be compressed over the flexible posts and then released from locking position 10 times. Observance of proper functioning of locking devices shall be made during this procedure.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Plastic, coated-cloth, and duck bound, stiff cover. Five plastic, coated-cloth and duck bound binders, of like description, shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665 or PPP-B-676. The box shall be closed to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.1.2 Pressboard, flexible cover. Ten pressboard binders of like description shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676. The box shall be closed to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.1.3 Posts and assembly and loading instructions. Posts, as specified (see 1.2.1.2 and 3.9), shall be packaged in a paper envelope or polyethylene bag and closed in accordance with normal commercial practice. Assembly and loading instructions when furnished separately (see 3.11), shall be packaged in the envelope with the posts with each binder.

5.1.3 Level C. The binders and posts shall be packaged to insure protection during shipment and safe delivery to destination.

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5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Binders of like description, packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in the quantities specified in the contract or order (see 6.2), in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The boxes shall be closed, water-proof sealed, and strapped in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636. The gross weight shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Binders of like description packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Quantities of unit packages to a shipping container shall be as follows:

		Unit packages
Plastic	(see 5.1.1.1)	3
Coated-cloth and duck	(see 5.1.1.1)	4
Flexible pressboard	(see 5.1.1.2)	5

Closure of shipping containers shall be in accordance with method II of the appendix to PPP-B-636. The gross weight shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The binders packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed to comply with the Uniform Freight Classification rules or the National Motor Freight Classification rules, as applicable.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2, as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The binders covered by this specification are intended for use as follows:

Types I and II, class 2, style B, grades B and C binders are designed primarily for heavy-duty use.
Types I and II, class 1, style A, grade A through C binders are designed for medium-to and including heavy-duty use.
Types I and II, class 1, grade D binders are designed primarily for light-duty use. The binders can be eventually used for storage purposes.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type, class, style, grade, sheet size, capacity, and color of binder required (see 1.2.1.1, 1.2.1.2, and 1.2.1.3).
(c) Specify when paperboard requirements (for cover construction) are other than that specified in 3.1.4.
(d) Accessory requirements. Suspension (hanger) bars, 3.8; and replacment posts, 3.9. When suspension bars are required, include manufacturer of rack or cabinet which binders will be used.
(e) Post hole spacing requirements - all binders (see 3.5).
(f) Any special features required (see 3.6).
(g) Levels of packaging and packing and any special marking for shipment required (see 5.1, 5.2 and 5.3).
(h) Quantity for level A packing (see 5.2.1).

6.3 Tightening or removal of posts specified in 3.9 should be interpreted to mean by means of a small screwdriver or other applicable device.

DOD WAIVED COORDINATION

User Interest:

Army - GL

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 15 cents each.

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